

THE GEOMETRIC DESIGN SYSTEM

Comprehensive brand guidelines for website, portfolio, case studies, marketing, social, presentations, documents, motion and AI-assisted asset creation.



Version 2.0 · 23 September 2026 · Master visual reference system

System map

This is the master reference. Every future asset should inherit from these rules unless a deliberate exception is documented.

01	Brand strategy	Positioning, personality, voice, principles
02	Visual DNA	The geometric language and source imagery
03	Design tokens	Colour, typography, spacing, radius, borders, shadows
04	Geometry	Planes, facets, cuts, framing, composition
05	Iconography	Icon family, construction, sizing and usage
06	Typography	Font hierarchy, styles, numerals, labels
07	Photography	Composition, colour grade, cropping, treatment
08	Illustration	Geometric editorial realism and subject integrity
09	UI system	Navigation, buttons, cards, forms, states
10	Layout	Grid, spacing, responsive behaviour
11	Case studies	Authentic screenshot banner system
12	Marketing	Campaigns, social, ads, email, print
13	Presentation	PPT / keynote / PDF slide language
14	Documents	Reports, proposals, resumes, one-pagers
15	Motion	Transitions, video, reels, kinetic type
16	Data & diagrams	Charts, timelines, process diagrams
17	AI asset creation	Master prompts and QA
18	Governance	Approval checklist, versioning, exceptions

Brand strategy

A premium personal brand for a product-minded digital professional.

POSITIONING

Aashish Pandey is positioned at the intersection of product thinking, design, technology and delivery. The visual system should therefore feel more like a considered design practice than a generic personal website.

Brand promise

Make complex digital work understandable, credible and visually memorable.

PERSONALITY

Analytical	Structured information, explicit hierarchy, evidence-led case studies.
Technical	Systems, diagrams, architecture, implementation detail where useful.
Design-literate	Strong composition, typography, visual craft and restraint.
Premium	Few elements, excellent spacing, deliberate materiality.
Human	Real photographs, journeys, environments and personal perspective.
Confident	Short sentences, clear ownership, no inflated claims.
Curious	Experiments are allowed, but remain inside the system.

VOICE

Clear · calm · specific · intelligent · direct. Write like a practitioner explaining decisions to another practitioner. Avoid corporate filler, superlatives without evidence, and generic “innovation” language.

Visual DNA

The supplied motorcycle artworks are the canonical reference for the brand's visual character.

SIGNATURE FORMULA

Real subject + geometric deconstruction + tactile surface + cinematic environment
+ restrained natural colour.



The two additional artworks expand the reference set: the system must support both close editorial portrait framing and wider narrative scenes while retaining the same geometric vocabulary.



Design tokens

The values below are the default design language. Client projects may introduce their own brand colours inside defined containment rules.

COLOUR TOKENS

Ink	#202524	Primary dark	Text, logo, navigation, high-contrast surfaces
Night	#171B1A	Deep dark	Hero backgrounds, dark sections, video
Forest	#3E4A3D	Structural green	Artwork planes, secondary UI
Deep Forest	#28352D	Dark green	Large fields, image framing
Olive	#77734B	Natural midtone	Supporting planes, borders
Moss	#65724D	Organic green	Secondary accents
Muted Gold	#B39A55	Premium accent	Highlights, rules, active details
Ochre	#9A843F	Warm accent	Selective campaign emphasis
Sand	#EEE4CF	Light neutral	Backgrounds, paper, cards
Cream	#F5F0E5	Soft neutral	Large quiet surfaces
Sky	#5E97AF	Signature blue	Hero skies, selected interactive states
Pale Blue	#8AAEBC	Light blue	Secondary surfaces
Slate	#5A7275	Cool neutral	Metadata, captions, secondary text
Terracotta	#B96540	Rare warm accent	Only when composition needs heat

COLOUR BEHAVIOUR

Base: Ink / Sand / Cream. Environment: Sky / Forest / Olive. Accent: Gold or Terracotta. Keep strong accents rare. Do not combine every token in one composition.

Typography & font styling

Typography is deliberately neutral so the geometric artwork remains the personality carrier.

PRIMARY FAMILY – LATO

LATO BLACK / LATO BOLD / LATO SEMIBOLD / LATO MEDIUM / LATO REGULAR

Display XL	Black	64–88 px	42–56 px	Hero statement / campaign title
Display L	Black	48–64 px	36–44 px	Page title
H1	Bold	36–48 px	30–36 px	Major section
H2	Bold	24–32 px	22–28 px	Section
H3	Semibold	18–22 px	18–20 px	Card / subsection
Body L	Regular	18 px / 1.55	17 px / 1.55	Long-form reading
Body	Regular	16 px / 1.55	16 px / 1.55	Default
Meta	Medium	11–13 px	11–12 px	Labels / dates
Micro	Bold	9–10 px	9–10 px	Eyebrow / taxonomy
Code / data	Mono	12–14 px	11–13 px	URLs, metrics, technical labels

TYPESETTING RULES

Use sentence case for most copy. Uppercase is reserved for micro labels, categories and navigation accents. Use a maximum of two weights within a single block. Keep line lengths around 55–75 characters for long-form copy. Avoid justified text.

Numerals should be tabular where metrics are compared. Use a monospace face only for technical or data-oriented moments, never as decorative body text.

Iconography

A custom geometric icon language connects the UI to the illustration system.

ICON PRINCIPLE

Icons are structural symbols, not decorative illustrations. They use simple strokes, sharp geometry and generous negative space.

 Plus	 Arrow	 Chevron	 External	 Play	 Pause
 Check	 Close	 Search	 Menu	 Link	 Diamond
 Triangle	 Square	 Circle	 Location	 Calendar	 Star

Construction	24×24 base grid; optical alignment over mathematical rigidity.
Stroke	1.5 px default; 2 px for emphasis; consistent terminals.
Corners	Mostly sharp; use small radii only when the symbol requires it.
Filled icons	Reserved for high-emphasis actions such as play, active state or status.
Colour	Default Ink. Active state may use Sky or Gold. Avoid multi-colour icons.
Size	16 / 20 / 24 px UI sizes; 32 px only for feature-level illustrations.
Touch target	Minimum 44×44 px clickable area, even when icon itself is 20–24 px.
Consistency	Never mix outline libraries with a different visual language in the same interface.

Geometry & composition

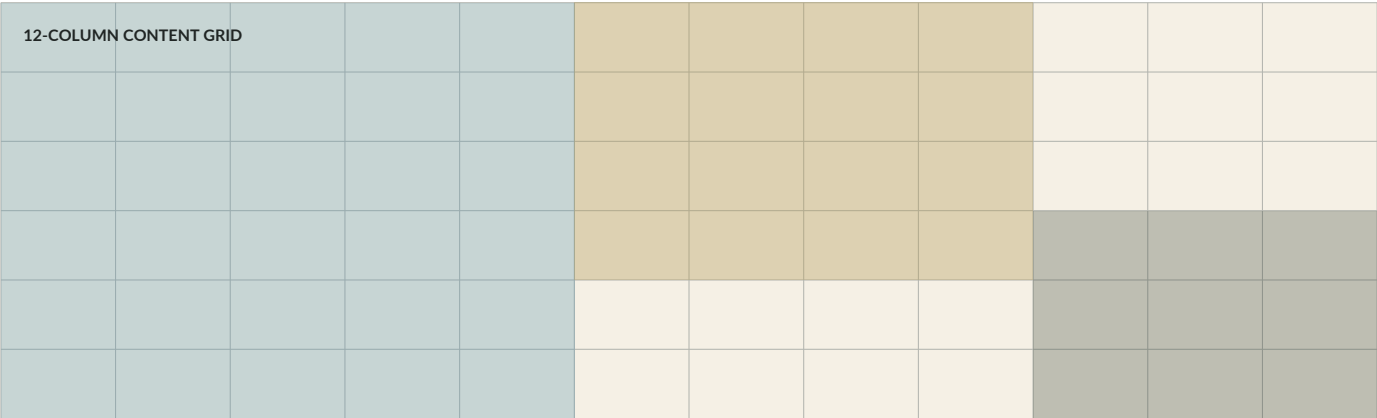
A construction grammar that can be used for posters, banners, social posts, diagrams and motion.

GEOMETRIC PRIMITIVES

Plane	Large polygon	Establish environment and major visual mass
Facet	Medium polygon	Model subject surfaces and controlled shading
Shard	Small polygon	Detail only where the eye needs texture
Cut	Negative wedge	Separate subjects and create movement
Frame	Edge crop	Make compositions feel full-bleed and editorial
Route	Angular line	Direct eye movement or explain a process

COMPOSITION HIERARCHY

1. Subject / message → 2. environment → 3. directional geometry → 4. micro-detail. If everything is equally detailed, the image loses hierarchy.



For mobile artwork, preserve a safe area around the face, logo and critical text. Allow geometry to crop off the canvas; the edge should feel intentional, never accidental.

Material, texture & surface

The artwork should feel printed, tactile and crafted rather than digitally airbrushed.

SURFACE STACK

Base colour	100%	Flat plane colour establishes the object.
Paper grain	4-10%	Fine, irregular, visible at close inspection only.
Print variation	2-5%	Tiny tonal inconsistencies; never obvious noise.
Edge softness	0-3%	Avoid razor-perfect digital edges where a printed feel is desired.
Shadow planes	10-30%	Use graphic angular shadows, not glossy 3D shading.
Highlight planes	5-15%	Use sparingly; preserve material hierarchy.

NEVER

Do not add film grain, chromatic aberration, excessive paper noise, fake lens flares, plastic highlights, bevelled 3D surfaces or generic “AI texture.” Texture should support geometry.



Photography direction

Photography supplies truth and personality; geometric treatment supplies the signature.

SHOT PRIORITIES

Subject integrity	Preserve face, body, clothing, pose and recognizable objects.
Composition	Use strong foreground / middle / background separation.
Perspective	Prefer natural perspective; avoid extreme distortion unless editorially intentional.
Lighting	Directional, natural, cinematic; retain believable skin and material response.
Environment	Choose locations with strong planes, texture, depth or negative space.
Crop	Create dedicated 16:9, 4:5, 3:4 and 9:16 crops; do not rely on one universal crop.
Colour	Grade toward the brand palette while retaining natural skin tones.

PORTRAIT INTEGRITY

The geometric effect may simplify the image, but it must not change identity, anatomy, expression or meaningful object relationships. When the source contains a person, recognizability is a hard requirement.

Illustration & AI art direction

The canonical prompt framework for future image creation.

MASTER ART DIRECTION

Premium geometric editorial illustration based faithfully on the supplied reference. Preserve the subject's identity, pose, anatomy, wardrobe, object relationships and environment. Deconstruct the image into large coherent low-poly / cubist planes, medium facets and a limited number of purposeful shards. Use tactile paper texture, subtle print imperfections, graphic light and shadow, cinematic foreground/middle/background depth, strong directional composition, intentional negative space and a muted natural palette derived from the Aashish Pandey brand system. Full-bleed, sophisticated, modernist, highly composed, unmistakably geometric.

NEGATIVE PROMPT

Photorealism; generic 3D render; plastic CGI; cartoon anatomy; random tiny triangles; excessive fragmentation; melted facial features; changed identity; altered pose; extra fingers/limbs; fake logos; invented UI; excessive glow; neon gradients; lens flare; watermark; text unless requested.

VARIATION CONTROL

Change composition, camera crop, environment or palette emphasis between assets — not the underlying identity system. A series should feel related without becoming identical.

Subject & object integrity

The person and the important object must survive the transformation.

Face	Identity, proportions, expression, hair, beard, gaze	Planes, tonal transitions, texture
Body	Anatomy, pose, silhouette	Clothing folds, shadow planes
Motorcycle / product	Recognizable proportions, controls, key branding	Surface planes, reflections, colour blocking
Architecture	Structural logic, openings, perspective	Materials, texture, simplified geometry
Landscape	Horizon, major forms, spatial relationships	Clouds, foliage, mountains, tonal grouping
Logo	Exact geometry when supplied	Placement and scale only

IDENTITY TEST

View the asset at 10–15% scale. If the subject becomes ambiguous, simplify the background before simplifying the subject. The face, silhouette and main object should remain the strongest recognition anchors.

UI foundation

The website is intentionally calmer than the artwork.

Page	Cream / Sand / Night	Pure-white SaaS look on every page
Navigation	Minimal, typographic	Oversized pill menus
Button	Rectangular / lightly rounded	Pill buttons everywhere
Card	Flat, bordered, low shadow	Heavy glassmorphism
Input	Simple border, strong focus	Decorative floating labels
Tag	Microtype + subtle background	Rainbow badges
Divider	1 px neutral rule	Heavy ornamental separators
Modal	Quiet, high contrast	Excessive blur / glow

CORNER LANGUAGE

Default radius: 0–4 px. Artwork remains sharp and angular. Larger radii are permitted only when a client interface requires them or when a content object clearly benefits from softness.

SHADOW LANGUAGE

Prefer tonal separation and borders. If a shadow is needed: low opacity, large blur, minimal vertical offset. Never use obvious floating-card shadows as the dominant visual style.

UI states & interaction

Interaction should feel deliberate and physical rather than flashy.

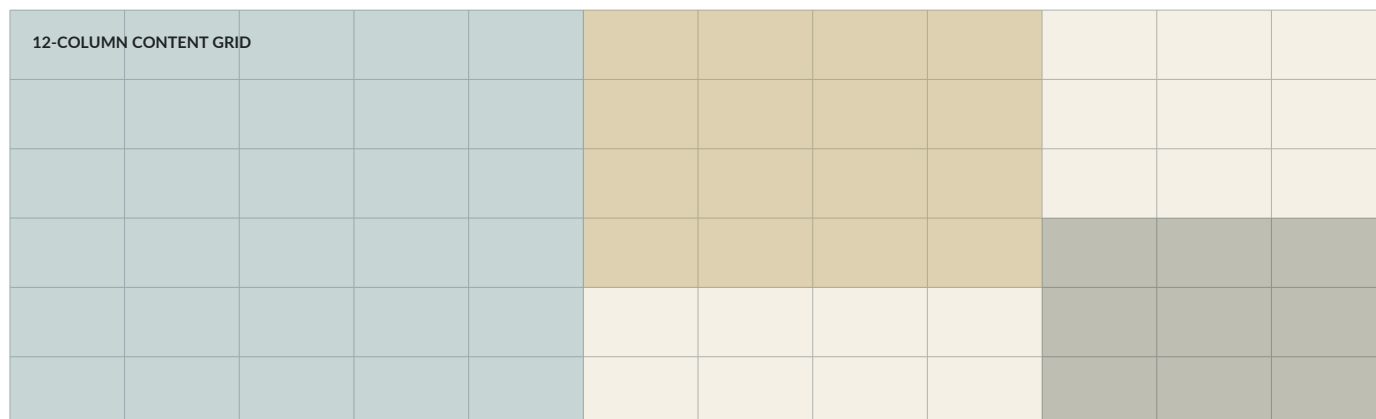
Default	Stable, quiet	Ink / neutral border
Hover	Small geometric reveal or tonal shift	Sky / Gold accent
Focus	Highly visible keyboard focus	2 px outer ring; never remove
Pressed	Shortened elevation / darkened surface	Ink / deeper tonal plane
Active	Persistent selection	Gold rule or Sky plane
Disabled	Reduced contrast, preserved legibility	Slate / 45–55%
Success	Clear but restrained	Forest / Moss
Warning	Rare and explicit	Ochre
Error	Direct, factual	Terracotta / Red

MOTION RULE

Interaction should communicate where something went, what changed, or what can be done next. Avoid animation that exists only to demonstrate technology.

Layout, grid & spacing

A disciplined grid prevents the expressive visual language from becoming chaotic.



4	4 px	Fine adjustment
8	8 px	Base spacing unit
16	16 px	Default internal gap
24	24 px	Component gap
32	32 px	Section gap
48	48 px	Major separation
64	64 px	Large section separation
96	96 px	Hero / editorial breathing room
128	128 px	Large visual reset

GRID RULE

Use the grid to organize content, then allow the hero artwork to break it deliberately. The break should feel authored — not like an alignment failure.

Responsive art direction

Every aspect ratio is a composition, not merely a crop.

Desktop hero	16:9	Subject can sit off-centre; generous horizontal negative space.
Portfolio card	4:3 / 3:2	Strong subject + concise metadata.
Social portrait	4:5	Subject-first; large type if needed.
Story / mobile	9:16	Top-to-bottom visual narrative; safe zones.
Square	1:1	Central focal point; strongest for avatars / compact promos.
Print A4	210×297 mm	Editorial hierarchy; 3 mm bleed where printed.
Presentation	16:9	Large visual, short copy, one idea per slide.

MOBILE SAFE AREA

Keep critical faces, logos and copy away from the outer ~8–10% of the canvas unless intentional edge cropping is part of the design.

Case-study banner system

The visual frame is branded. The website screenshot itself must remain truthful.

AUTHENTICITY RULE

Never fabricate a client website screenshot. Use an actual captured screenshot from the live site, a supplied screenshot, or clearly label any reconstruction as a mockup / concept. Do not redraw a UI and present it as evidence.

01 / Screenshot	Evidence	Real screen capture; preserve UI fidelity.
02 / Device frame	Context	Consistent browser/device frame across projects.
03 / Geometric field	Personal brand	Planes, crops, texture and colour framing.
04 / Metadata	Context	Client, role, scope, year — concise.
05 / Outcome	Proof	Only include measurable / verifiable outcomes.

BANNER COMPOSITION

Recommended: 60–75% real screenshot / work evidence + 25–40% personal-brand framing. Keep the client UI itself visually accurate even when the surrounding banner is highly stylized.

Marketing & campaign system

The same identity must survive outside the portfolio.

LinkedIn / professional post	1200×1200 or 1200×1500	One idea; strong headline; visual evidence.
Story / vertical campaign	1080×1920	Large focal image; safe top/bottom zones.
Landscape social	1200×628	Short statement + strong image crop.
Website campaign hero	16:9 or full-bleed	Art first; copy second.
Email hero	~1200 px wide source	Keep message legible without relying on tiny type.
Print poster	A-series / custom	Use vector type and 300 dpi raster imagery.
Digital ad	Platform-specific	Create dedicated crops; never auto-shrink one master.

CAMPAIGN RULE

Every campaign has one visual idea + one message + one action. If a campaign needs more information, move it into the landing page or supporting content rather than overcrowding the hero.

Social content architecture

A repeatable family of post types makes the brand recognizable before the logo appears.

Project reveal	Hero artwork → project title → role	Full-bleed geometry + quiet type
Before / after	Two controlled frames → short explanation	Angular divider, no gimmicky split-screen
Process	3-5 steps → one takeaway	Diagrammatic planes + numbered labels
Insight	Large statement → evidence	Minimal field + one geometric accent
Metric	Large number → context → source	Strong numeral hierarchy
Behind the work	Real photo → caption	Light geometric framing only
Case-study teaser	Screenshot → problem → CTA	Authentic UI + branded frame

SOCIAL COPY

Lead with the actual idea. Avoid “Excited to share...”, “Thrilled to announce...” and generic achievement language. State what happened, why it mattered and what you learned.

Presentation / pitch deck system

Presentations should feel like the portfolio became a room.

01 Cover	Title + one image	Minimal; establish visual world.
02 Context	Problem / situation	No more than 3–5 facts.
03 Challenge	What had to change	One clear statement.
04 Approach	Framework / process	Use diagrams, not paragraphs.
05 Work	Screens / artifacts	Large visuals, short annotation.
06 System	Architecture / design system	Show repeatability.
07 Outcome	Metrics / evidence	Source every important number.
08 Learnings	What changed in thinking	Honest and concise.
09 Closing	Next step / contact	One action.



Documents, proposals & reports

Formal materials should inherit the same visual system without becoming poster-like.

Cover	Large title + small metadata + one restrained geometric field.
Header	Minimal; avoid heavy corporate bars.
Body	16–18 px equivalent digital reading size; generous line-height.
Tables	Neutral grid, bold headers, restrained accent.
Callout	Use Sand / Sky / Forest block; one key point only.
Footer	Document title / version / page number.
Charts	Simple, labelled, no 3D effects.
Appendix	Technical detail can become denser, but preserve hierarchy.

VERSION CONTROL

Every serious document should expose version, date, owner and status where relevant. This supports the “evidence over noise” positioning.

Diagrams, data & information design

Technical thinking is part of the identity; diagrams should therefore be as carefully designed as hero images.

Bar / column	Compare quantities.
Line	Show change over time.
Donut / pie	Use only for simple part-to-whole relationships.
Timeline	Show project phases and milestones.
Architecture map	Show systems, integrations and dependencies.
Process flow	Show sequence, ownership and decision points.
2×2 matrix	Show two meaningful dimensions; label axes precisely.

DATA VISUALISATION RULES

No 3D charts. No decorative gradients. Use Ink for primary series, Sky / Forest / Gold for supporting series. Label values directly where possible. Include source and date for external data.

The geometry system may appear as background planes, section markers or route lines — never at the cost of chart readability.

Motion & video

The visual system can move without becoming a motion-graphics showcase.

Reveal	Plane slides / clips into place.
Transition	Geometric wipe or restrained crossfade.
Hover	Small crop shift / plane reveal / tonal change.
Scroll	Parallax only when it improves depth.
Kinetic type	Short, deliberate, readable.
Video grade	Natural skin + muted environmental palette.
Loop	6–12 seconds for atmospheric assets; avoid infinite attention traps.

TIMING

Micro-interaction: ~150–250 ms. Content transition: ~300–500 ms. Editorial reveal: ~600–900 ms when justified. These are starting points, not rigid laws.

ACCESSIBILITY

Respect reduced-motion preferences. Never communicate essential information through motion alone.

Print & physical applications

The same geometry should translate cleanly to physical media.

A4 / A3 poster	Use vector geometry, 300 dpi raster images, 3 mm bleed.
Business card	One strong side; keep small type above practical print limits.
Letterhead	Minimal header; generous writing area.
Resume	Evidence-first layout; no decorative overload.
Notebook / merch	Monochrome AP mark or geometric crop preferred.
Sticker	Use a simplified monogram or single geometric motif.
Photo print	Full-bleed artwork with small metadata line.

PRINT COLOUR

For production printing, convert colours according to the printer’s requested profile. Do not assume screen HEX values will reproduce identically in CMYK.

Email, signature & utility assets

Small-format assets should be restrained and extremely legible.

Email signature	Name / role / website / one contact channel; optional tiny AP mark.
Favicon	Monochrome AP monogram or geometric cut; no detail.
OG image	Large project title + signature artwork; keep type away from crop edges.
Link preview	One focal image + one clear title.
Profile avatar	Real portrait or simplified monogram; avoid busy background.
Loading state	Quiet geometric plane sequence; no fake progress unless real.
404	One geometric illustration + useful navigation back to work/home.

Logo / AP monogram system

The monogram should be ownable, reproducible and useful at tiny sizes.

CONSTRUCTION PRINCIPLES

Primary	Geometric AP mark with controlled negative space.
Secondary	Wordmark: AASHISH PANDEY in uppercase / tracking.
Monochrome	Required master version.
Reverse	White mark on Ink / Night.
Small-size	Simplified silhouette; no fine internal cuts.
Clear space	Minimum 1× the monogram's stroke/height around the mark.
Do not	Stretch, bevel, add gradients, outline, rotate or place inside arbitrary badges.



Logo development note: the visual identity is strong enough to allow the monogram to remain intentionally minimal. The artwork system should never depend on the logo to create recognition.

AI-assisted asset production

A reusable prompt architecture for future creative work.

PROMPT ORDER

Reference fidelity → subject → composition → geometric language → material → colour → lighting → typography (if needed) → output → negative constraints.

MASTER TEMPLATE

“Use the supplied reference as the source of truth. Preserve [SUBJECT / IDENTITY / OBJECT / POSE]. Recompose into [FORMAT]. Create a premium geometric editorial illustration using [LARGE PLANES / FACETS / CONTROLLED SHARDS]. Use tactile [PAPER / PRINT] surface, cinematic [LIGHTING], restrained Aashish Pandey palette, strong [FOREGROUND / MIDGROUND / BACKGROUND] separation and intentional negative space. Keep [CRITICAL ELEMENTS] unmistakably recognizable. No [NEGATIVE LIST].”

BRAND-SAFE NEGATIVE LIST

No invented logos, fake client UI, altered identity, altered anatomy, random fragmentation, generic 3D, glossy plastic surfaces, neon colour, excessive glow, stock-photo composition, decorative text, watermark or meaningless visual clutter.

Asset QA & approval

Nothing becomes a published brand asset without passing this gate.

01	Truth	Are screenshots, logos, metrics and claims authentic?
02	Identity	Is the person / product / object still recognizable?
03	Geometry	Are planes intentional rather than random?
04	Hierarchy	Can the main idea be understood immediately?
05	Typography	Are size, weight, line length and spacing consistent?
06	Colour	Is the palette restrained and coherent?
07	Accessibility	Is contrast sufficient and information not motion-dependent?
08	Responsive	Does the composition survive the target crop?
09	Technical	Correct dimensions, resolution, compression and file format?
10	Brand fit	Would this look natural beside the other portfolio assets?

PUBLISH ONLY WHEN ALL TEN ARE SATISFIED.

Do / don't matrix

Use this page as the fastest reference when creating an asset.

Large coherent planes	Hundreds of tiny random facets
Real screenshots	Invented client interfaces
Strong subject hierarchy	Equal detail everywhere
Tactile paper texture	Heavy digital noise
Natural colour + one accent	Rainbow palettes
Sharp geometry	Generic rounded SaaS graphics
Short copy	Paragraphs inside hero artwork
Evidence and metrics	Unsupported superlatives
Real identity	AI-generated generic replacement person
Purposeful motion	Continuous visual distraction
Accessible contrast	Low-contrast "luxury" text
Consistent icons	Mixed icon families

Asset matrix

A single system should cover the entire personal brand ecosystem.

Website	Hero	Geometric artwork / project screenshot
Website	Case study	Authentic screenshot + geometric frame
Website	About	Real portrait + restrained geometry
Website	Blog	Editorial image + typography
Social	Post	Insight / project / process template
Social	Story	Vertical visual narrative
Social	Profile	Portrait or monogram
Marketing	Campaign	One idea + one hero + CTA
Presentation	Deck	Large visual + concise evidence
Documents	Proposal	Editorial cover + structured body
Documents	Resume	Evidence-first professional layout
Print	Poster	Full-bleed geometric artwork
Print	Card	Monogram + restrained typography
Motion	Reel	Plane-based transitions
Motion	Intro	Monogram / geometric reveal
Product	Merch	Simplified mark / signature motif
Utility	Favicon	Monochrome simplified mark
Utility	OG image	Project title + authentic hero image

Governance & versioning

The brand system should become more precise over time, not more complicated.

v1.0	Core identity / initial visual grammar.
v1.1	Minor token or component updates; no structural change.
v2.0	Major identity or design-system change.
Archive	Deprecated assets retained for reference; never used in new work.

EXCEPTION RULE

A client's brand system may override colour, logo and UI treatment inside the client work itself. The personal brand governs framing, storytelling, typography around the work, authenticity, image treatment and portfolio composition.

SYSTEM RULE

When uncertain, remove an element before adding one. The identity gains strength through consistency and restraint.

THE SYSTEM IN ONE SENTENCE



This is the master creative constitution for Aashish Pandey's personal brand. It is designed to guide website design, portfolio case studies, marketing campaigns, social content, presentations, documents, print, motion and AI-assisted creative production.

Reference images: the supplied geometric motorcycle artworks are treated as canonical visual references for the illustration language.